accuracy which is helpful for prompt decision-making. Follow-Up actions are also taken quickly if records of the past correspondence are easily available.

Do You Know?

India Office Records:

- The India Office Records are the documentary archives of the administration in London of the pre-1947 government of India.
- The 14 kilometres of shelves of volumes, files and boxes of papers, together with 70,000 volumes of official publications and 1,05,000 manuscript and printed maps, comprise the archives of the East India Company (1600-1858), of the Board of Control or Board of Commissioners for the Affairs of India (1784-1858), of the India Office (1858-1947), of the Burma Office (1937-1948), and of a number of British agencies overseas which were officially linked with one or other of the four main bodies. The India Office Records are part of the Public Records of the United Kingdom, and are open for public consultation

5.4.2. Organization of Filing:

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In any large business establishment, the management has to decide whether filing should be centralized (i.e.: Spread among the different departments). The main object filing is speedy and accurate location of records at minimum cost. This is best achieved under the centralized filing arrangement.

1. Centralized Filing of Records or Centralized Filing:

Centralized filing of records refers to graphing and storing of records in the same place where they are accessible to a number of persons. In other words, the records pertaining to activities of all the departments of an enterprise are preserved in the centralized index plan. Central file comprises papers relating to general correspondence, office branch correspondence, orders, invoice, vouchers, estimate, quotations, credit and debit memos and other papers which several departments need to refer.

(i) Merits of Centralized Filing:

1. It eliminates duplication, as all papers pertaining to a particular subject are kept in the central file thus eliminating duplication.
2. This system provides better service by employing trained clerks exclusively for filing purpose.
3. It ensures a more uniform system of filing.
4. It helps to save time as there is only one place to send material for filing and locate the same.
5. It provides economy in space, equipment and supplies as there is no duplication of records and equipments.
6. It helps to serve other departments by relieving them from the burden of maintaining the records.

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